

module-04-doshas - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - senior band

Module 4 — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Tri-doṣa* · **Band:** Senior (9-12) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

Three biological rhythms in Āyurvedic thought.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 4's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

“Modern personality psychology has ~6 big frameworks (Big Five, MBTI, RIASEC, etc.). Āyurveda has had ONE for ~2500 years: tridoṣa. What does that say about (a) the durability of the framework and (b) the limits of pre-modern psychology?”

Core idea · 15 min

Tridoṣa as biological-rhythm framework.

1. **Vāta (motion).** Modern parallels: autonomic nervous system arousal, peristaltic + circulatory rhythms.
2. **Pitta (transformation).** Modern: metabolic rate, thermoregulation, inflammatory response.
3. **Kapha (structure).** Modern: anabolic/structural metabolism, parasympathetic dominance.

The mapping is not 1:1, but the empirical observations behind each doṣa are well-attested (Caraka *Sūtrasthāna* 12).

Honest critique: Tridoṣa is not a clinical-diagnostic tool by modern medical standards. It IS a useful self-observation framework. Most users err by reading it as diagnostic — that's a category mistake.

Demonstration · 10 min

The 30-question prakṛti survey. Distribute the Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya *Sūtrasthāna* 1-derived survey. Students fill in 10 minutes. Most score as *dvi-doṣa* (mixed) — that’s the expected result. Discussion: why is mono-doṣa rare?

Source moment · 5 min

Quoted verse. Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.57:

vāyuh pittaṁ kaphaścoktaḥ śārīro doṣa-saṅgrahaḥ

“Wind, bile, and phlegm — this is the summary of the bodily doṣas.”

Note: this verse does NOT say “diseases.” It says “doṣas” — functional principles. Treating them AS diseases is a modern misreading. The translation “humour” or “principle” is more accurate.

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Doṣa critical-reading exercise. Distribute 3 short pop-Āyurveda blog excerpts. Pairs evaluate: is the claim (a) traditional, (b) empirically testable, (c) overreach? Develop a scoring rubric together.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“Distinguish: where IS tridoṣa empirically defensible? Where is it culturally meaningful but empirically weak? Where would treating it as diagnosis cause harm?” — 3 paragraphs.

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Three doṣas — introduction
- **Day 02** — Vāta — the motion principle
- **Day 03** — Pitta — the transformation principle
- **Day 04** — Kapha — the structure principle
- **Day 05** — Mapping doṣas to the five elements (Module 2)
- **Day 06** — Prakṛti self-assessment
- **Day 07** — Daily doṣa rhythms (kapha morning, pitta noon, vāta evening)
- **Day 08** — Seasonal doṣa rhythms
- **Day 09** — Balance vs imbalance (sāmya vs vaiṣamya)

- **Day 10** — Synthesis + 7-day self-observation project

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.